

and your unique money box will take six months to construct. But once done, you have a grid that works on its own and needs a minor tweak just once in a while.

Interwoven into this book are stories and case studies of some of the hundreds of people who have written to me on the four TV shows I have done, in the last ten years, and responded to the column I write in *Mint*. Equally interwoven is a larger perspective of why we are faced with a marketplace that is predatory. You will understand why the government's need to finance its deficit leads to you buying toxic products.

Yup, there's a link. You will understand why the global financial sector wants you to feel stupid. You will understand how you are actually doing the best you can in a marketplace that is full of sharks. You will see that you are not a money dummy.

Think about it: How does the toughest value-for-money *kitna-deti-hai* person suddenly become stupid when it comes to money?

You will understand that the current 'buyer beware' in the financial sector – or transferring of responsibility to the investor of buying the right financial product – is a regulatory failure. It is not unlike a car vendor flinging open the bonnet and saying: 'Go do your due diligence and ensure this car is safe.'

Asking an average person to understand concepts of present value, future value, real return and so on is no different from asking him to buy a car after ensuring that the engine is safe! You will understand why the regulatory changes under way are so important for your future.

The book is not going to give you a prescriptive road map. It is more of a direction. A way to think about your financial life with some rules of thumb that you can modify according to your own situation. You need to engage with it and personalize it.

May your money box be full of good things, always.